Crown, Church or Parliament (1517–1689)

KNOWLEDGE RETRIEVAL & HOMEWORK COMPANION • 30 HIGH-YIELD QUESTIONS

Pupil Name: _____ **Class:** _____ **Teacher:** _____



The Armada Portrait of Queen Elizabeth I (c. 1588) • Commemorating the defeat of the Spanish Armada; Elizabeth's hand rests on the globe, symbolizing emergent Protestant naval dominance.

LESSON ENQUIRY FOCUS	HW DUE DATE	1. SOLO (WRITTEN)	2. PARTNER (VERBAL)	PARENT / TEACHER SIGN
Enquiry 1: Reformation & Break with Rome Martin Luther (1517), Catherine of Aragon, 1534 Act of Supremacy, Dissolution of Monasteries & Thomas Cromwell		/ 6	/ 6	
Enquiry 2: Elizabeth I & The Middle Way 1559 Elizabethan Settlement, Supreme Governor, Via Media, recusancy fines & Mary Queen of Scots		/ 6	/ 6	
Enquiry 3: The Spanish Armada (1588) Francis Drake, 1587 Cadiz Raid, Spanish Crescent formation, Calais fireships & Battle of Gravelines		/ 6	/ 6	
Enquiry 4: Civil War, Regicide & 1689 Divine Right, Ship Money, English Civil War, New Model Army, 1649 Regicide & 1689 Bill of Rights		/ 6	/ 6	
Enquiry 5: Crown, Church or Parliament Verdict Supreme Governor, Act of Uniformity, King-in-Parliament, 1688 Glorious Revolution & constitutional monarchy		/ 6	/ 6	

HOW TO COMPLETE YOUR RETRIEVAL CYCLES:

1. SOLO (WRITTEN): Complete your 6 write-in lines from memory without looking. Check your answers in green pen using the Department Marking Bank on Pages 7–8.

2. PARTNER (VERBAL): Hand your booklet to a **PARENT, CARER, FAMILY MEMBER, OR STUDY BUDDY** to test you out loud from the Marking Bank until you hit 6/6!

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Access online self-marking retrieval flashcards, diagnostic feedback, and audio narration at the-history-revision-hub.netlify.app.

1. ► **In what year did German monk Martin Luther nail his 95 Theses to the church door in Wittenberg, sparking the Protestant Reformation?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

2. ► **What landmark statutory law passed by Parliament in 1534 officially declared Henry VIII the Supreme Head of the Church of England?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

3. ►► **Why did Pope Clement VII refuse to grant Henry VIII an annulment from his first wife, Catherine of Aragon, in 1527?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

4. ►► **How did chief minister Thomas Cromwell use the Dissolution of the Monasteries (1536–1540) to transform royal finances?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

5. ►►► **Why did Sir Thomas More choose execution rather than swear Henry VIII's Oath of Supremacy in 1535?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

6. ►►► **Why did Henry VIII's use of parliamentary statutes to break with Rome inadvertently elevate Parliament's future sovereignty?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: | Martin Luther (1517) | Indulgences | Act of Supremacy (1534) | Catherine of Aragon | Dissolution of Monasteries | Thomas Cromwell

7. ► **What moderate title did Elizabeth I adopt in the 1559 Act of Supremacy to avoid offending both Catholics and Protestants?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

8. ► **What Latin term describes Elizabeth I's strategic policy of balancing Protestant doctrine with traditional ceremonial rituals?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

9. ►► **Why did the 1559 Act of Uniformity impose 12d fines on Catholic recusants rather than executing them for heresy?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

10. ►► **Why did Mary, Queen of Scots become a lethal existential threat to Elizabeth following her flight to England in 1568?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

11. ►►► **How did Sir Francis Walsingham's intelligence network uncover undeniable proof of Mary's treason in the 1586 Babington Plot?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

12. ►►► **Why was the execution of Mary, Queen of Scots at Fotheringhay Castle in February 1587 such a dangerous gamble for Elizabeth?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: | Supreme Governor (1559) | Via Media (Middle Way) | Mary Queen of Scots | Act of Uniformity | Recusancy Fines | Francis Walsingham

13. ► **In what year did Sir Francis Drake lead a daring raid on Cadiz harbour, famously "singeing the King of Spain's beard"?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

14. ► **What disciplined, impenetrable defensive naval formation did the 130 ships of the Spanish Armada maintain sailing up the Channel?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

15. ►► **How did Lord Howard and Drake break the defensive Spanish crescent formation off Calais on the night of 7 August 1588?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

16. ►► **Why were English "race-built" galleons technologically superior to the floating fortress galleons of the Spanish Armada?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

17. ►►► **Why was the Battle of Gravelines (8 August 1588) the decisive turning point that ended the Spanish invasion threat?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

18. ►►► **How did Elizabethan propaganda use the stormy "Protestant Wind" to legitimize the English victory?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: | Francis Drake | Cadiz Raid (1587) | Crescent Formation | Fireships at Calais | Battle of Gravelines | Protestant Wind

19. ► **What political doctrine held that King Charles I was chosen directly by God and could not be questioned by Parliament?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

20. ► **What controversial coastal naval tax did Charles I illegally enforce on inland English counties without parliamentary consent in 1635?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

21. ►► **What disciplined, religiously zealous military force did Oliver Cromwell organise that crushed the Royalist Cavaliers at Naseby in 1645?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

22. ►► **On what historic date was King Charles I publicly beheaded outside the Banqueting House in Whitehall for high treason against his people?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

23. ►►► **Why was the trial and execution of King Charles I an unprecedented constitutional earthquake across Europe?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

24. ►►► **How did the landmark Bill of Rights (1689) permanently transform the British system of government?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: | Divine Right | Ship Money | Oliver Cromwell | New Model Army | Regicide (30 Jan 1649) | Bill of Rights (1689)

25. ► **In 1517, to which foreign spiritual leader was the English church and monarch legally subordinate?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

26. ► **What foundational constitutional term describes supreme sovereignty held jointly by the monarch, House of Lords, and House of Commons?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

27. ►► **Why did James II's attempt to restore Catholic absolutism trigger the bloodless Glorious Revolution of 1688?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

28. ►► **How did the Toleration Act of 1689 begin to end 170 years of violent religious persecution in England?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

29. ►►► **Between Crown, Church, and Parliament, which institution emerged as the ultimate victor by 1689?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

30. ►►► **How did the constitutional settlement of 1689 lay the foundation for Britain's rise as an industrial and global empire?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: | Supreme Governor | Act of Uniformity | King-in-Parliament | Glorious Revolution (1688) | Toleration Act | Constitutional Balance

Department Marking Bank • Part 1

Green-Pen Verification Key • Enquiries 1 to 3 (Questions 1 to 18)

ENQUIRIES 1–3

ENQUIRY 1: REFORMATION & BREAK WITH ROME

1. ► **1517** — *Luther's protest attacked the corrupt sale of Catholic indulgences, challenging the Pope's spiritual authority across Europe.* [✓] [X]

2. ► **The Act of Supremacy (1534)** — *The statute severed all legal ties with the papacy, transferring papal taxation and spiritual authority to the English Crown.* [✓] [X]

3. ►► **The Pope was held captive by Catherine's nephew, Holy Roman Emperor Charles V** — *Following the Sack of Rome, imperial troops occupied the Vatican, making it politically suicidal for the Pope to insult the Emperor by annulling the marriage.* [✓] [X]

4. ►► **Confiscating vast monastic estates and gold to double the Crown's annual income and sell land to loyal gentry** — *Over 800 abbeys and convents were seized, funding coastal artillery forts and binding the landowning class permanently to the Protestant Reformation.* [✓] [X]

5. ►►► **He believed papal supremacy was divine law that no secular king or parliament could lawfully overturn** — *More's martyrdom established the enduring legal principle of individual moral conscience standing in defiance of state-mandated ideological conformity.* [✓] [X]

6. ►►► **It established the precedent that royal supremacy required statutory legislation from Parliament to become valid law** — *By using MPs to legislate religious doctrine and taxation, Henry unintentionally proved that the Crown could not govern England without parliamentary consent.* [✓] [X]

ENQUIRY 2: ELIZABETH I & THE MIDDLE WAY

7. ► **Supreme Governor of the Church of England** — *Elizabeth avoided claiming Christ-like spiritual supremacy, satisfying moderate Catholics while asserting legal royal control over the bishops.* [✓] [X]

8. ► **Via Media ("The Middle Way")** — *The settlement retained traditional church vestments, choral music, and bishops while enforcing an English Book of Common Prayer.* [✓] [X]

9. ►► **Elizabeth refused to "make windows into men's souls" and wanted to avoid creating sympathetic Catholic martyrs** — *Enforcing outward civic attendance at Sunday services through financial penalties neutralized widespread rebellion without igniting religious war.* [✓] [X]

10. ►► **As an anointed Catholic great-granddaughter of Henry VII, she was viewed by Catholic Europe as the rightful Queen of England** — *Mary became the figurehead of repeated foreign-backed plots (Northern Earls, Ridolfi, Throckmorton, Babington) aiming to assassinate Elizabeth.* [✓] [X]

11. ►►► **Intercepting, deciphering, and resealing Mary's coded letters smuggled inside beer barrels** — *Cryptanalyst Thomas Phelippes decoded Mary's letter approving the assassination of Elizabeth, giving Parliament the evidence to demand her execution.* [✓] [X]

12. ►►► **It violated the sacred immunity of an anointed monarch and directly provoked Philip II of Spain to launch the Armada** — *Beheading a crowned monarch horrified European Catholic courts and provided King Philip II with a holy crusade justification to invade England.* [✓] [X]

ENQUIRY 3: THE SPANISH ARMADA (1588)

13. ► **1587** — *Drake destroyed 30 Spanish warships and thousands of seasoned barrel staves, delaying the invasion fleet by a full twelve months.* [✓] [X]

14. ► **A crescent formation (crescent crescent)** — *Heavily armed galleons guarded the curved flanks, protecting weaker transport ships in the center from English broadsides.* [✓] [X]

15. ►► **Launching eight blazing fireships packed with pitch and gunpowder into the anchored Spanish fleet** — *Panic-stricken Spanish captains cut their anchor cables in the dark to escape the inferno, scattering their ships into the North Sea.* [✓] [X]

16. ►► **Hawkins designed them lower, sleeker, and armed with long-range culverin broadside guns on 4-wheel trucks** — *English ships sailed closer to the wind and could reload broadsides in minutes, keeping distance to avoid Spanish boarding soldiers.* [✓] [X]

17. ►►► **English cannons pounded the scattered Spanish ships at point-blank range, driving them into the stormy North Sea** — *Spanish galleons were battered by culverins, ran out of ammunition, and were blocked from rendezvousing with Parma's army in Flanders.* [✓] [X]

18. ►►► **It claimed God sent divine gales to shipwreck Spanish vessels along the Irish rocks, proving God favored Protestant England** — *Commemorative medals were stamped with "God blew and they were scattered", cementing Protestant national identity and naval mythology.* [✓] [X]

Department Marking Bank • Part 2

Green-Pen Verification Key • Enquiries 4 to 5 (Questions 19 to 30)

ENQUIRIES 4–5

ENQUIRY 4: CIVIL WAR, REGICIDE & 1689

19. The Divine Right of Kings — *Charles believed his royal authority came from God alone, dismissing Parliament for eleven years of personal rule (1629–1640).* ► [✓] [X]

20. Ship Money — *Landowner John Hampden was put on trial for refusing to pay twenty shillings, turning Ship Money into a national symbol of royal tyranny.* ► [✓] [X]

21. The New Model Army — *Promoting soldiers by merit and fighting skill rather than aristocratic birth, the Ironside cavalry outmatched the King's armies.* ►► [✓] [X]

22. 30 January 1649 — *The Rump Parliament convicted the King as a "tyrant, traitor, murderer, and public enemy", abolishing the monarchy and declaring a Republic.* ►► [✓] [X]

23. It was the first time in European history that an anointed monarch was formally tried and executed by his own subjects for treason — *It shattered the myth of the Divine Right of Kings, proving that sovereign rulers could be held legally accountable for slaughtering their citizens.* ►►► [✓] [X]

24. It outlawed royal taxation and standing armies without parliamentary approval, establishing a Constitutional Monarchy — *Following the Glorious Revolution, William and Mary accepted that Parliament held ultimate legislative and financial supremacy over the Crown.* ►►► [✓] [X]

ENQUIRY 5: CROWN, CHURCH OR PARLIAMENT VERDICT

25. The Pope in Rome — *England was an integral province of Catholic Christendom, answering to canon law courts in the Vatican.* ► [✓] [X]

26. The King-in-Parliament — *It encapsulates the British constitutional principle that ultimate sovereign authority resides in legislation enacted jointly by Crown and Parliament.* ► [✓] [X]

27. Whig and Tory nobles united to invite Protestant William of Orange to invade and defend English Protestant laws — *When James had a Catholic son, MPs feared a permanent Catholic Stuart dynasty, prompting the King to flee to France.* ►► [✓] [X]

28. Granting freedom of worship to Protestant dissenters (Baptists, Presbyterians, and Quakers) — *While Catholics were still excluded from public office, the state abandoned the Tudor fantasy that a single unified Church could be enforced by execution.* ►► [✓] [X]

29. Parliament emerged as the supreme sovereign power, holding total control over national taxation, laws, and the royal succession — *No British monarch could ever again suspend laws, raise taxes without consent, or claim divine absolutism without facing deposition.* ►►► [✓] [X]

30. It provided stable, predictable rule of law that protected private property, encouraged commerce, and attracted capital — *Unlike absolute European monarchies prone to arbitrary confiscation, Britain's parliamentary stability enabled the creation of the Bank of England and global trade dominance.* ►►► [✓] [X]

UNIT CONCEPTUAL FOUNDATIONS • 4 CORE ANCHORS

ROYAL SUPREMACY: The constitutional doctrine established by the 1534 Act of Supremacy declaring the English monarch the supreme governor of the Church in place of the Pope.

DIVINE RIGHT: The political belief held by Stuart kings that monarchs are appointed directly by God and cannot be held accountable by any earthly body, including Parliament.

CONSTITUTIONAL MONARCHY: A system of government where the monarch's sovereign powers are strictly limited by law and shared with an elected Parliament (established in 1689).

REGICIDE: The deliberate execution of an anointed king, enacted on 30 January 1649 when Parliament tried, convicted, and beheaded Charles I for high treason against his people.